

PASSOVER FUN FACTS



The Afikomen is the last piece of food eaten at the seder. The word afikomen is the Hebrew form of the Greek word epikomion, which

means dessert. The afikoman is a substitute for the Korban Pesach (Pascal Sacrifice), which was the last thing eaten at the Passover Seder during the eras of the First and Second Temples.

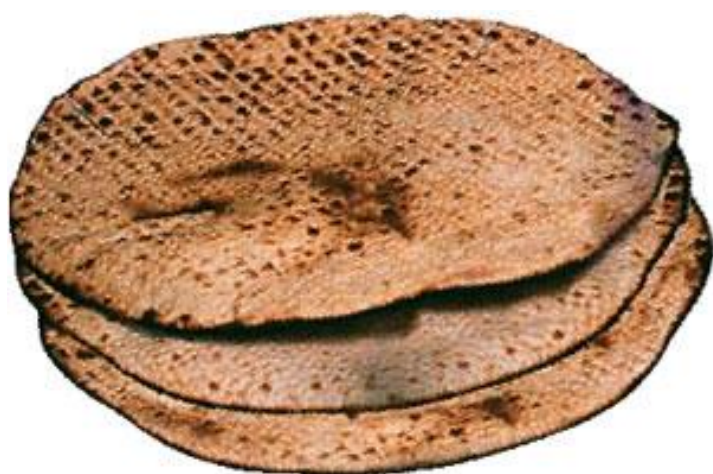
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On every seder table there is a symbolic fifth cup of wine called the “Cup for Elijah.”

There is a teaching that the Prophet Elijah will answer Jewish legal questions that the ancient rabbis could not resolve. One of these questions was whether we drink four or five cups of wine or grape juice at the seder. We hope that Elijah will visit us on the night of the seder. If that happens, Elijah will tell us whether we should drink four or five cups. Elijah will also be able to drink the cup that is set aside for him.

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Three pieces of matzah are placed in the middle of the table. They

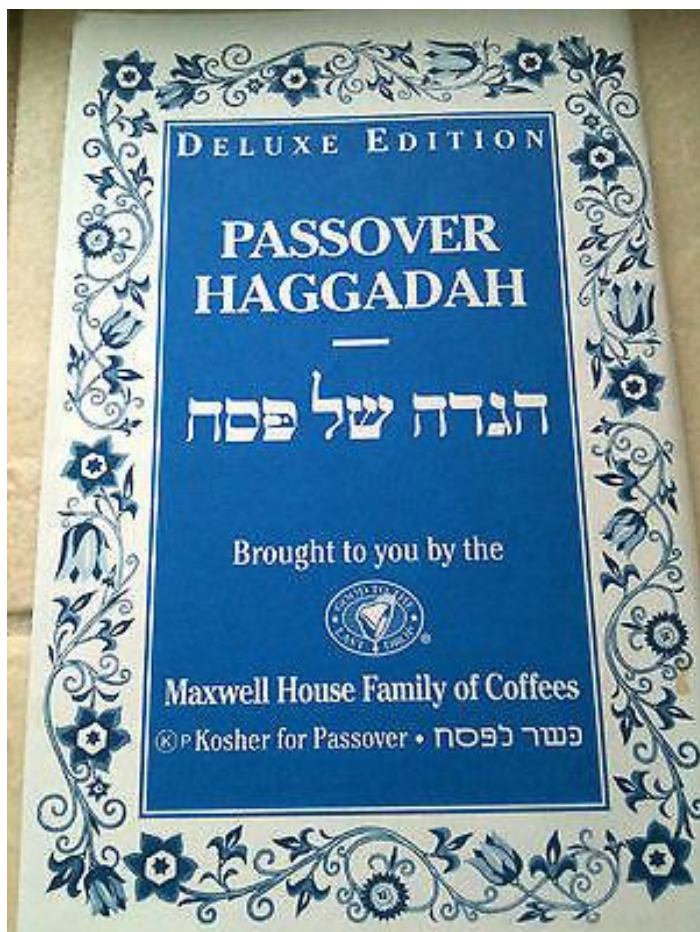
represent the three classes of Jewish people in ancient times: the Kohens — the priestly class responsible for the administration of the Temple sacrifices, the Levites — the priestly class responsible for the actual performance of the Temple sacrifices, and the Israelites — all other Jews.

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The exodus from Egypt is such an important event in Jewish history that it is mentioned several times in the daily prayers.

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In the mid
1930s,
Maxwell
House
started
giving out
Haggadot
to clarify

that coffee beans are kosher for
Passover, and thus prevent a dip
in coffee sales. Distributed
nearly every year since, there
are now more than 50 million
copies in print.

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Persian
Jews
distribut
e green
onions
during
the song Dayenu and hit
each other with the
stalks when the ninth
stanza begins.

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In the British territory of Gibraltar, Jews actually mix the dust of bricks into their charoset, a symbol of the mortar used to hold together the brick walls the Jews built in Egypt.

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According to the Guinness Book of World Records, the world's largest matzah ball was unveiled in Tucson, Arizona, in 2010. Weighing in at 488 pounds, this giant matzah ball was made from more than 1,000 eggs and 125 pounds of matzah meal.

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Coca-Cola makes a special batch of kosher-for-Passover Coke with real sugar instead of high-fructose corn syrup, because corn products are forbidden during the holiday. Look for the bottles with yellow caps.

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In Vilna, Poland, during World War I, it was very difficult to find kosher wine. Rabbinical authorities made a special announcement to allow sweet tea to be substituted for the traditional four cups of wine during the seder.

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When we left Egypt, the Torah recounts that God told us to remember and tell our story. The Torah commands us to tell

the story of our Exodus to our children each and every year on Passover. Having a Seder and telling the story of how God redeemed us from slavery and brought us into freedom fulfills that promise. The word Haggadah means 'to tell' or 'to relate'. The Haggadah itself is our script for telling the story.

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Freedom from slavery did not take place in one sudden flash. When the Torah describes the transition it uses four different words to indicate four stages, known as “the four expressions of redemption.” The four cups of wine correspond to them: “I will remove you, and I will rescue you, I will redeem you and I will take you out.”

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The Hebrew word Seder means 'Order' or 'Arrangement.' The Passover Seder has 15 sequential steps, and thus, the word Seder is used to describe the evening.

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The World's Largest Passover Seder Takes Place in Nepal. Each year members of the Chabad-Lubavitch movement hold their "Seder on Top of the World" in Kathmandu for Jewish locals and travelers alike. Last year they had around 2,000 people attend the festivities.